



AFRICAN SOLIDARITY CIVIC ORGANISATION (ASCO)

Registered NPC: 2026/521895/08

SARS Approved PBO: 930092287

Section 18A application pending

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www.africansolidaritycivic.org

CORPORATE CSI PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Johannesburg Stock Exchange (JSE Limited) × ASCO

Youth Financial Capability and Sustainable Community Action Pilot

Requested CSI investment: R100,000

Proposed implementation area: Gauteng, initially in the Johannesburg/Sandton catchment, with a design that can be adapted for wider South African delivery if JSE requests national reach.

Prepared: October 2026

Confidential proposal for corporate CSI / ESG consideration. This document presents a proposed partnership and does not represent an award, endorsement, existing partnership or company commitment.

Executive summary

ASCO is seeking a strategic corporate CSI partnership with **Johannesburg Stock Exchange (JSE Limited)** to support a measurable public-benefit initiative: **Youth Financial Capability and Sustainable Community Action Pilot**. The proposed request is **R100,000**, to be applied to direct programme delivery, participation access, safety, learning materials, monitoring and accountable reporting.

ASCO is a South African Non-Profit Company and a SARS-approved Public Benefit Organisation, reference number **930092287**. ASCO's **Section 18A application is currently pending**; ASCO does not represent that it has Section 18A approval or that current donations are Section 18A tax deductible.

The proposal in one sentence: Youth Financial Capability and Sustainable Community Action Pilot in Gauteng, initially in the Johannesburg/Sandton catchment, with a design that can be adapted for wider South African delivery if JSE requests national reach., benefiting Proposed: 80-120 underserved secondary-school learners and young adults in Gauteng, prioritising youth with limited access to financial-literacy, civic-engagement and practical sustainability opportunities; final age range, schools and selection process to be agreed with JSE and local stakeholders. through a locally designed, monitored and reportable intervention aligned with Johannesburg Stock Exchange (JSE Limited)'s publicly documented priorities, subject to the company's confirmation of eligibility and application requirements.

What ASCO is requesting

R100,000 in CSI support, or a partial/in-kind contribution structured with the company.

What the funding would enable

Direct activities, participation access, safe delivery, community materials, monitoring and a close-out report.

About ASCO

ASCO is a community-focused civic organisation promoting social justice, community development, active citizenship, African unity, environmental sustainability, inclusion and sustainable public-benefit action. ASCO works through advocacy, education, grassroots initiatives, humanitarian and community-development activities, partnerships and practical interventions.

ASCO is governed by four Directors. The Board governs and Executive Management manages. ASCO maintains governance, donation, safeguarding, financial-management, data-protection, monitoring and reporting instruments for responsible partnership administration.

ASCO's primary contact for this proposal is:

Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu

Executive Director

African Solidarity Civic Organisation (ASCO)

PBO Reference: 930092287

Tel: +27 76 757 5773

Website: <https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/>

The proposed project

Project title Youth Financial Capability and Sustainable Community Action Pilot	Implementation period Proposed 6–12 month pilot, with final schedule agreed after eligibility, baseline and permissions are confirmed.
Location Gauteng, initially in the Johannesburg/Sandton catchment, with a design that can be adapted for wider South African delivery if JSE requests national reach.	Target beneficiaries Proposed: 80-120 underserved secondary-school learners and young adults in Gauteng, prioritising youth with limited access to financial-literacy, civic-engagement and practical sustainability opportunities; final age range, schools and selection process to be agreed with JSE and local stakeholders.

Proposed outputs and targets

The following are proposed planning targets, not completed results. Final targets should be agreed with the company after baseline assessment, budget confirmation and any required stakeholder permissions.

- Proposed: 8-10 facilitated workshops covering budgeting, saving, responsible investing, entrepreneurship and civic participation, using age-appropriate material.
- Proposed: 2-3 practical public-benefit sustainability activities selected with the host community, such as a recycling, greening or clean-up action, subject to permissions and feasibility.
- Proposed: reach 80-120 direct youth beneficiaries and at least 200 indirect community members through take-home resources and community activation.
- Proposed: pre/post knowledge checks, attendance and demographic records, safeguarding documentation, expenditure evidence and a concise outcome report to the funder.
- Proposed: one youth-led showcase or presentation demonstrating learning and community benefit; no result should be represented as completed before delivery.

Expected outcomes

- Improved community participation and practical public-benefit action in the selected location.
- Improved access to relevant learning, environmental, inclusion, humanitarian or youth-development support, depending on the project design.
- Documented implementation evidence, beneficiary participation and lessons for continuation or scale-up.
- Clear accountability through expenditure records, activity updates, monitoring information and a close-out report.

Why this matters

The proposed intervention responds to a community-development need through the sequence **community need** → **practical intervention** → **measurable result**. The final baseline will verify the

specific need, beneficiary profile, site conditions, permissions and appropriate indicators before implementation.

ASCO will avoid overstating the problem or claiming results in advance. Where waste, participation, learning, environmental condition, referrals or other outputs are measurable, ASCO will use simple evidence tools such as attendance registers, baseline/endline checks, activity logs, photographs with consent, beneficiary feedback and expenditure records.

Evidence discipline: All numbers in this proposal are either company-reported context from official sources or clearly labelled ASCO planning targets. No completed result, partnership or funding commitment is claimed.

Why Johannesburg Stock Exchange (JSE Limited)?

A R100,000 ASCO proposal could cautiously align with JSE's evidenced youth-development and financial-literacy orientation by delivering a transparent, community-based youth programme in Gauteng that combines practical financial/investment literacy, civic participation and sustainable public-benefit activities. Alignment is thematic only: JSE's public pages evidence a bursary and Investment Challenge, but do not confirm a general community-grant window, support for ASCO's exact model, or any commitment to fund it. ASCO should present itself accurately as a South African NPC with SARS-approved PBO reference 930092287 and state that its Section 18A application is pending.

Verified company context

- JSE describes its Empowerment Fund bursary as supporting students and developing future South African leaders; the published programme targets previously disadvantaged South African citizens in specified undergraduate/postgraduate years and selected fields of study.
- The JEF bursary page specifies a defined eligibility model: full-time study, 2nd/3rd year or Honours, minimum 70% aggregate, household-income ceiling of R650,000, and attendance at one of the listed South African universities. This is evidence of a youth/education priority, not evidence that JSE accepts general unsolicited CSI proposals.
- JSE's official Schools Investment Challenge describes itself as a learning initiative for learners throughout South Africa, focused on learning about finance and investment and understanding the JSE; 2026 registration is shown as open on the official programme site.
- JSE's sustainability-report landing page says its sustainability report sets out its approach and commitments to support and drive sustainable value creation.
- JSE's official contact page lists its head office at One Exchange Square, Gwen Lane, Sandown, 2196, South Africa, telephone +27 11 520 7000 and info@jse.co.za; its enquiry form includes a Sponsorships enquiry type.

Company facts are drawn from official sources reviewed for this proposal. They describe public priorities or reported company activity; they are not promises of funding to ASCO.

Indicative project budget

The requested amount is allocated transparently across delivery and accountability categories. The budget is indicative and should be refined with the company after the implementation site, beneficiary profile, quotations and eligible-cost rules are confirmed.

Budget category	Indicative amount	Use
Direct programme implementation	R60,000	Core activities, local delivery inputs and community implementation for the proposed project.
Participant transport and access	R8,000	Reasonable access support to enable participation, subject to eligibility and records.
Safety equipment and participant welfare	R6,000	PPE, first aid, safeguarding, water/refreshments and safe participation requirements.
Educational and mobilisation materials	R8,000	Learning resources, community mobilisation and accessible communication.
Monitoring, evaluation and reporting	R7,000	Baseline, attendance, outcome tracking, documentation and close-out reporting.
Volunteer/project coordination	R7,000	Scheduling, volunteer support, stakeholder coordination and implementation management.
Reasonable administration	R4,000	Reasonable project administration directly attributable to delivery; no inflated overheads.
Total requested CSI investment	R100,000	Equals the proposed request.

Administration is limited to a reasonable project share. ASCO will not promise audited financial statements unless they are available; it will provide appropriate project expenditure records and supporting documentation.

Partnership options

Option A — Full project funding

Company funds the proposed project at R100,000, subject to approval and agreement.

Option B — Partial project funding

Company contributes a defined portion of the budget, with scope and outputs adjusted transparently.

Option C — Multi-phase partnership

Company supports a pilot followed by an agreed continuation or scale-up phase based on evidence.

In-kind or technical support

Where relevant, equipment, expertise, access or employee volunteering may complement cash support, subject to written agreement.

Accountability and reporting

ASCO will maintain appropriate records relating to funded activities and can provide, subject to agreed requirements:

- Project implementation updates
- Expenditure records and supporting documentation
- Attendance and participation information where appropriate and lawfully collected
- Photographs and activity evidence with appropriate consent
- Safeguarding and incident records where relevant
- Monitoring and outcome information
- Activity and close-out reports

ASCO will agree reporting frequency, eligible costs, procurement expectations, data protection, branding, acknowledgement and any site-access or technical requirements before implementation. Any use of company branding or recognition will be subject to written approval.

Initial contact route

Use JSE's official enquiry form at <https://www.jse.co.za/contact-us> and select the Sponsorships enquiry type, addressing the proposal to the appropriate corporate affairs/ESG or sponsorship team. General contact: info@jse.co.za, +27 11 520 7000. The JEF bursary contact (JEF@jse.co.za) is published for bursary applications and should not be assumed to handle CSI proposals.

ASCO welcomes an initial discussion to confirm whether the proposed project is within the company's current CSI/ESG remit, whether unsolicited proposals are accepted, what documents are required, and whether the full, partial or in-kind partnership option is most suitable.

Important conditions and open questions

- No official JSE page reviewed establishes an open application process or eligibility criteria for general CSI/community grants; sponsorship enquiry is the safest initial route.
- The JEF bursary criteria should not be treated as the criteria for this proposed project; they are student-specific and restrictive.
- Do not claim JSE funding, partnership, endorsement, prior results or an approved Section 18A certificate for ASCO.
- JSE's published Investment Challenge is finance/investment education; acceptance of broader youth/community-development or environmental activities would require written confirmation.
- Confirm current budget cycle, due diligence, governance documents, safeguarding requirements, monitoring/reporting expectations, branding rules and whether the requested R100,000 may be paid to an organisation whose Section 18A application is pending.

These cautions are included to prevent overstatement. They should be resolved with the company before ASCO treats the proposal as eligible or finalises a submission budget.

Closing

ASCO believes meaningful social and environmental progress is achieved through collaboration between communities, civil society and responsible corporate partners. We invite **Johannesburg Stock Exchange (JSE Limited)** to join us in delivering measurable public-benefit impact through a carefully scoped and accountable partnership.

Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu

Executive Director

African Solidarity Civic Organisation (ASCO)

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Official sources and verification links

Important company and programme information in this proposal was checked against the following official sources:

1. <https://www.jse.co.za/our-business/jef-bursary>
2. <https://schools.jse.co.za/>
3. <https://group.jse.co.za/media/document/report/sustainability-report>
4. <https://group.jse.co.za/sites/ir.jse.co.za/files/media/documents/3%20-%20JSE%20Ltd%20%E2%80%93%20Sustainability%20Report%202023%20%E2%80%93%2028032024%20-%20As%20published.pdf>
5. <https://www.jse.co.za/contact-us>

Source review and proposal preparation date: October 2026. Company information and application routes can change; ASCO should confirm current requirements before submission.